

December

30

1986

Gas detectors

The British government announced plans to replace canaries in mines with electronic gas detectors. Canaries are more sensitive to poisonous gases than humans, so were taken down into mines as early warning systems.



Also on this day

1922 The Soviet Union was formed when Russia, Ukraine, Belarus, and the Transcaucasus (Georgia, Armenia, and Azerbaijan) approved the Treaty on the Creation of the USSR.

1924 US astronomer Edwin Hubble shared proof that galaxies (systems of millions or billions of stars) exist beyond our own Milky Way.

1927

Ginza line

The first underground railway in Asia began service in Tokyo, Japan. It proved so popular that people waited in line for two hours just to make a short journey.

534

Code of Justinian

A set of laws written down at the request of Byzantine emperor Justinian I came into effect throughout the Eastern Roman Empire. This law code forms the basis for many legal systems found in Europe today.



Born this day

1975 Tiger Woods, US golfer. He has spent more weeks as the No. 1 golf player in the world than anyone else.

1984 LeBron James, Black American basketball player. Recognized as one of the greatest basketball players ever, he has had a long career, which includes NBA Championship and Olympic wins.

